

US00PP33022P2

(12) **United States Plant Patent**
Kim

(10) **Patent No.:** **US PP33,022 P2**
(45) **Date of Patent:** **May 4, 2021**

(54) **PHLOX PLANT NAMED ‘BALSUKALAV’**

(50) Latin Name: *Phlox paniculata*
Varietal Denomination: **Balsukalav**

(71) Applicant: **Ball Horticultural Company**, West
Chicago, IL (US)

(72) Inventor: **Grace H. Kim**, Arroyo Grande, CA
(US)

(73) Assignee: **Ball Horticultural Company**, West
Chicago, IL (US)

(*) Notice: Subject to any disclaimer, the term of this
patent is extended or adjusted under 35
U.S.C. 154(b) by 0 days.

(21) Appl. No.: **17/005,959**

(22) Filed: **Aug. 28, 2020**

(51) **Int. Cl.**
A01H 5/02 (2018.01)
A01H 6/70 (2018.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**
USPC **Plt./320**
CPC *A01H 6/70* (2018.05)

(58) **Field of Classification Search**
USPC Plt./320
CPC A01H 6/70
See application file for complete search history.

Primary Examiner — Anne Marie Grunberg

(74) *Attorney, Agent, or Firm* — Audrey Charles

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named ‘Balsu-
kalav’, characterized by its deep red-purple colored flowers,
dark green-colored foliage, and vigorous, upright growth
habit, is disclosed.

1 Drawing Sheet

1

Latin name of genus and species of plant claimed: *Phlox*
paniculata.

Variety denomination: ‘Balsukalav’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Phlox* plant botanically known as *Phlox paniculata* and
hereinafter referred to by the cultivar name ‘Balsukalav’.

The new cultivar originated in a controlled breeding
program in Guadalupe, Calif. during September 2014. The
objective of the breeding program was the development of
Phlox cultivars with large sized flowers, increased powdery
mildew resistance and a vigorous, upright growth habit.

The new *Phlox* cultivar is the result of open-pollination.
The female (seed) parent of the new cultivar is the propri-
etary *Phlox paniculata* breeding selection coded PHL-791,
not patented, characterized by its medium purple-colored
flowers, medium green-colored foliage, and moderately vig-
orous, semi-upright growth habit. The male (pollen) parent
of the new cultivar is unknown. The new cultivar was
selected as a single flowering plant within the progeny of the
above stated open-pollination during August 2015 in a
controlled environment in Guadalupe, Calif.

Asexual reproduction of the new cultivar by terminal stem
cuttings since August 2015 in Guadalupe, Calif. and Elburn,
Ill. has demonstrated that the new cultivar reproduces true to
type with all of the characteristics, as herein described,
firmly fixed and retained through successive generations of
such asexual propagation.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following characteristics of the new cultivar have
been repeatedly observed and can be used to distinguish
‘Balsukalav’ as a new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant:

1. Deep red-purple colored flowers;
2. Dark green-colored foliage; and
3. Vigorous, upright growth habit.

2

Plants of the new cultivar differ from plants of the female
parent primarily in having deep red-purple colored flowers,
increased branching, and a more vigorous, upright growth
habit.

5 Of the many commercially available *Phlox* cultivars, the
most similar in comparison to the new cultivar is KA-POW
Lavender ‘Balkapolav’, U.S. Plant Pat. No. 30,780. How-
ever, in side by side comparisons, plants of the new cultivar
differ from plants of ‘Balkapolav’ in at least the following
characteristics:

- 10 1. Plants of the new cultivar have larger primary inflo-
rescences than plants of ‘Balkapolav’;
2. Plants of the new cultivar have larger diameter flowers
than plants of ‘Balkapolav’; and
- 15 3. Plants of the new cultivar have more main branches per
plant than plants of ‘Balkapolav’.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

20 The accompanying photographs show, as nearly true as it
is reasonably possible to make the same in color illustrations
of this type, typical flower and foliage characteristics of the
new cultivar. Colors in the photographs differ slightly from
the color values cited in the detailed description, which
25 accurately describes the colors of ‘Balsukalav’. The plants
were approximately five months old. The plants were grown
in one-gallon containers for approximately 12 weeks in an
outdoor nursery in West Chicago, Ill. Plants were given two
pinches prior to transplant.

30 FIG. 1 illustrates a side view of the overall growth and
flowering habit of ‘Balsukalav’.

FIG. 2 illustrates a close-up view of an individual inflo-
rescence of ‘Balsukalav’.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

35 The new cultivar has not been observed under all possible
environmental conditions to date. Accordingly, it is possible
that the phenotype may vary somewhat with variations in the

environment, such as temperature, light intensity, and day length, without, however, any variance in genotype.

The chart used in the identification of colors described herein is The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society, London, England, 2015 edition, except where
5 general color terms of ordinary significance are used. The color values were determined in July 2020 under natural light conditions in Naperville, Ill.

The following descriptions and measurements describe approximately five-month old plants produced from cuttings
10 from stock plants and grown under conditions comparable to those used in commercial practice. The plants were grown in one-gallon containers for approximately 12 weeks in an outdoor nursery in West Chicago, Ill. Plants were given two pinches prior to transplant. Prior to transplant plants were
15 grown in liners in a poly-covered greenhouse in West Chicago, Ill. Greenhouse temperatures ranged from an average high of 69.3° F. (20.7° C.) to an average low of 63.6° F. (17.6° C.), and supplemental lighting was provided daily for five hours during short days. Measurements and numerical
20 values represent averages of typical plants.

Botanical classification: *Phlox paniculata* 'Balsukalav'.

Parentage:

Female parent.—Proprietary *Phlox paniculata* breeding selection coded PHL-791, not patented.
25

Male parent.—Unknown.

Propagation:

Type cutting.—Terminal stem.

Time to initiate roots.—Approximately 10 to 12 days.
30

Time to produce a rooted cutting.—Approximately 42 to 49 days.

Root description.—Fine to medium thickness, medium density.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching, medium density.
35

Plant description:

Commercial crop time.—Approximately 10 to 12 weeks from a rooted cutting to finish in a 15 cm pot.

Growth habit and general appearance.—Herbaceous perennial, vigorous, upright growth habit.
40

Hardiness.—USDA Zone 4b (−20° F. to −25° F./−28.9° C. to −31.7° C.).

Size.—Height: Approximately 24.0 cm. Width: Approximately 38.0 cm.

Branching habit.—Freely branching, pinching will improve branching.
45

Branch.—Quantity: Approximately 9 main branches. Shape: Round. Strength: Strong. Length to base of inflorescence: Approximately 10.0 cm. Diameter: Approximately 3.0 mm to 4.0 mm. Length of central internode: Approximately 1.3 cm. Texture: Glabrous.
50 Color of young stems: 146B. Color of mature stems: 146B, becoming woody 199B to 199D with age.

Foliage description:

General description.—Quantity of leaves per main branch: Approximately 16. Fragrance: None detected. Form: Simple. Arrangement: Opposite, decussate.
55

Leaves.—Shape: Elliptic, slightly carinate. Margin: Entire, minutely ciliate. Apex: Acute. Base: Attenuate. Venation pattern: Pinnate. Length: Approximately 8.5 cm. Width: Approximately 3.2 cm. Texture of upper surface: Sparsely pubescent. Texture of lower surface: Glabrous. Color of upper surface of young foliage: 137A with venation of 146D. Color of lower surface of young foliage: Closest to 147B with
60 65

venation of 146D. Color of upper surface of mature foliage: Closest to but darker than NN137A with venation of 146D. Color of lower surface of mature foliage: Closest to 147B with venation of 146D.

Petioles.—Length: Approximately 3.0 mm. Width: Approximately 2.0 mm to 3.0 mm. Texture: Glabrous. Color: 146D.

Flowering description:

Flowering habit.—'Balsukalav' is a long day obligate and is freely flowering under outdoor growing conditions with substantially continuous blooming from late spring throughout summer.

Lastingness of individual flower on the plant.—Approximately 10 days.

Inflorescence description:

General description.—Type: Compound terminal panicle, flowers face upright and outwardly, self-cleaning. Quantity per plant: Approximately 7. Fragrance: Moderately sweet and pleasant. Height of primary: Approximately 9.5 cm. Width of primary: Approximately 14.0 cm. Quantity of fully open flowers per primary inflorescence: Approximately 26. Height of secondary: Approximately 6.5 cm. Width of secondary: 4.0 cm. Quantity of fully open flowers per secondary inflorescence: Approximately 1.

Peduncle.—Strength: Strong. Aspect: Primary erect, axillary acute angle to stem. Length of primary: Approximately 1.5 cm. Diameter of primary: Approximately 3.0 mm. Length of axillary: Approximately 2.0 cm. Diameter of axillary: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture: Densely pubescent. Color: 146B.

Flower description:

Type.—Single.

Bud.—Rate of opening: Generally takes 3 to 4 days for bud to progress from first color to fully open flower.

Bud just before opening.—Shape: Oblanceolate. Length: Approximately 1.9 cm. Diameter: Approximately 4.0 mm. Color: Calyx of 146D with a central stripe of N186A and petal portion of N81A to N81C.

Corolla.—Shape: Salverform. Diameter: Approximately 3.5 cm. Depth: Approximately 3.2 cm.

Petals.—Quantity: 5 in a single whorl, base fused into a narrow tube. Lobe shape: Obovate. Margin: Entire. Apex: Obtuse to slightly notched. Lobe length: Approximately 1.6 cm. Lobe width: Approximately 1.8 cm. Texture of upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color of upper surface when first open: N78B with NN78B, 67A at orifice. Color of lower surface when first open: N80D with NN78C. Color of upper surface when fully open: N78B to N78C tinted with N80B to N80C, 67A at orifice. Color of lower surface when fully open: N80D with N78C.

Corolla tube.—Length: Approximately 2.6 cm. Diameter at distal end: Approximately 3.0 mm. Diameter at proximal end: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture of outer surface: Moderately pubescent. Texture of inner surface: Smooth, glabrous with lower 5.0 mm densely pubescent. Color of inner surface: N81B with 145D at base. Color of outer surface: N78A to N78B, 145D at base.

Calyx.—Shape: Cupped. Length: Approximately 1.1 cm. Diameter: Approximately 3.0 mm.

Sepals.—Quantity per flower: 5, lower half fused. Shape: Lanceolate. Apex: Narrowly apiculate. Length: Approximately 1.1 cm. Width: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture of outer surface: Sparsely pubescent. Texture of inner surface: Smooth, gla- 5 brous. Color of inner surface: 146C with tip of N186A. Color of outer surface: 146D with tip and central streak of N186A.

*Pedice*l.—Strength: Strong, flexible. Aspect: Primary erect, axillary acute angle to peduncle. Length: 10 Approximately 3.0 mm. Diameter: Approximately 1.0 mm. Texture: Densely pubescent. Color: 146C typically tinted with N187A.

Reproductive organs.—Androecium: Stamen quantity: 5 per flower, adnate to corolla tube. Stamen length: 15 Approximately 2.5 cm. Filament length of free portion: Approximately 1.0 mm. Anther shape: Sagittate. Anther length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Anther

color: 158B. Pollen amount: Abundant. Pollen color: 155D. Gynoecium: Pistil quantity: 1 per flower. Pistil length: Approximately 2.4 cm. Stigma shape: Cleft, three-parted. Stigma length: Approximately 1.0 mm. Stigma color: 145D. Style length: Approximately 2.1 cm. Style color: Lighter than 145D and faintly tinted with N186A near stigma. Ovary length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Ovary color: 144A.

Seed and fruit production: Neither seed nor fruit production has been observed.

Disease and pest resistance: Increased resistance to powdery mildew has been observed.

What is claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named 'Balsukalav', substantially as herein illustrated and described.

* * * * *



FIG. 1

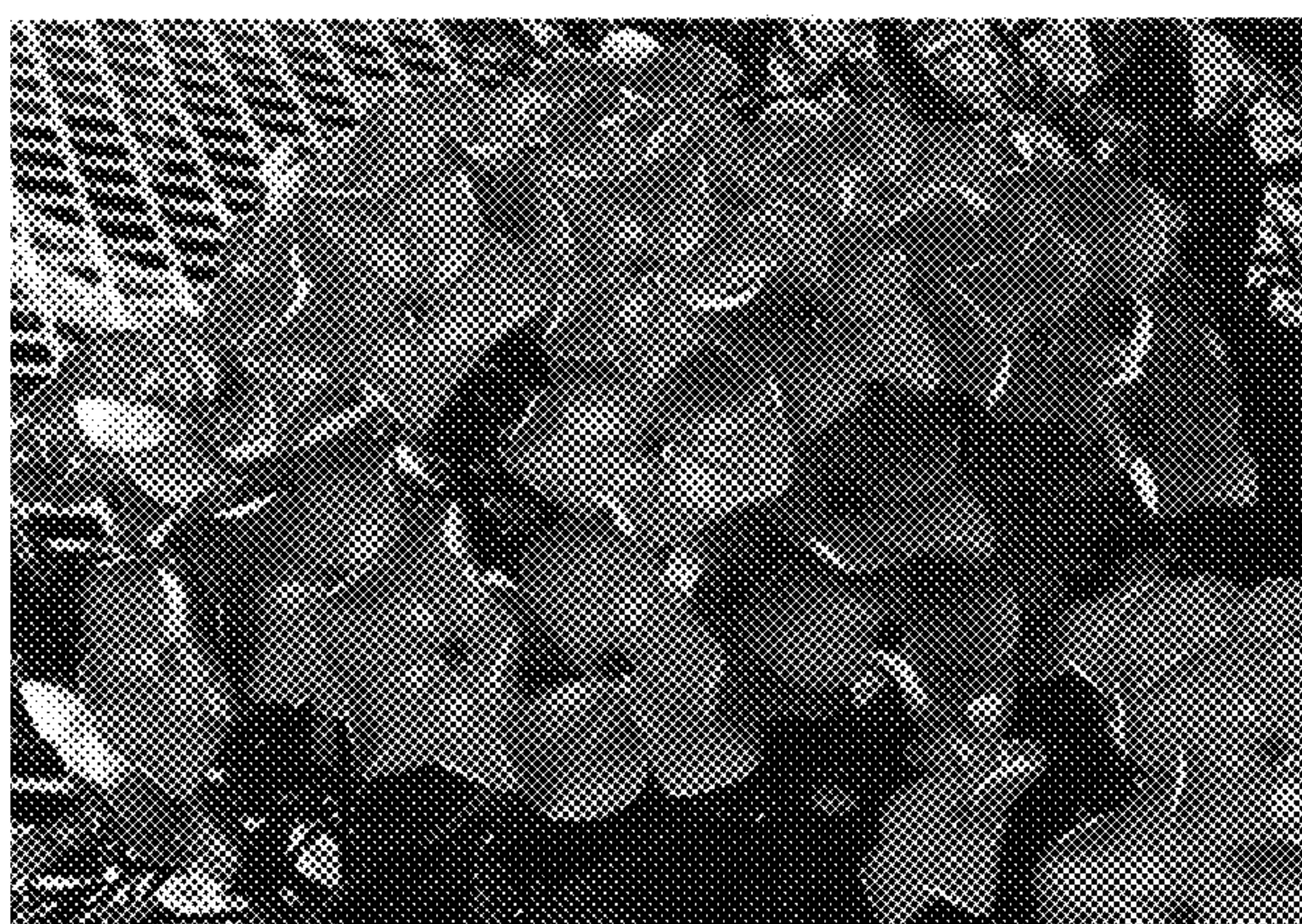


FIG. 2